Salah Yacoub

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Education

University of Central Florida — Orlando, FL

B.S. in Computer Science, focus on cybersecurity and cloud security; GPA: 3.76 — *Expected Fall 2028*

- **Relevant Coursework:** Security in Computing, Computer Science 1, Computer Logic and Organization, Object-Oriented Programming, Introduction to C Programming
- **Honors:** Florida Bright Futures Scholarship

Projects

Secure Static Photography Site on AWS | *S3, CloudFront, IAM, CloudTrail, GuardDuty* — Sep 2026

- Hosted a static site in a private S3 bucket reachable only through CloudFront, using Origin Access Control and enforced HTTPS.
- Wrote a custom least-privilege IAM policy scoped to the bucket's ARN with no wildcards, and verified that out-of-scope actions were denied.
- Enabled CloudTrail logging with a customer-managed KMS key and log file validation, and built a GuardDuty, EventBridge and SNS pipeline that emails Medium and High severity findings.
- Investigated a real GuardDuty finding on root credential usage and moved all routine work to a dedicated IAM user.

Knightro Tracker | *AWS Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB* — Oct 2026

- Built the original serverless AWS backend for a live campus sighting map on a four-person team at Knight Hacks IX; the team later moved to Supabase to add accounts and photo verification.
- Wrote two Lambda functions behind an API Gateway HTTP API: one validates and saves sightings to DynamoDB, the other returns only sightings from the last 20 minutes.
- Configured CORS on the API so the browser frontend could call it directly, and used DynamoDB on-demand mode to keep idle costs at zero.

Personal Portfolio Website | *AWS Amplify Hosting, IAM, GitHub, Claude Code* — Nov 2026

- Designed and deployed a personal portfolio on AWS Amplify Hosting with automatic deployments from a GitHub repository for the AWS Builder Center Student Hackathon.
- Directed an AI coding agent (Claude Code with the AWS Agent Toolkit) through a dedicated MFA-protected IAM user instead of root credentials, and reviewed every file before publishing to a public repo.
- Built an in-browser terminal with a capture-the-flag challenge whose answer is stored only as a hash, plus a canvas animation that reacts to the cursor.

Experience and Activities

Knight Hacks — Fall 2026

Member — *UCF, Orlando, FL*

- Competed in the Knight Hacks IX hackathon, building the Knightro Tracker backend on a four-person team.

Independent Delivery Driver — May 2026 – Present

DoorDash and Uber Eats — *Oviedo, FL*

- Manage my own schedule and deliveries while studying full time.

Technical Skills

Languages: Java, C, Python
Cloud: AWS S3, CloudFront, IAM, KMS, CloudTrail, GuardDuty, EventBridge, SNS, Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB, Amplify
Tools: Git, GitHub, Linux, AWS CLI, Claude Code
Certifications in Progress: AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner
Spoken Languages: English, Arabic